

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager, Identity & Trust Infrastructure.*

Positioning, fintech-native PM with 13 years shipping regulated B2B platforms, from payments to defence AI, ready to own the roadmap at Clera from day one.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY CLERA

Identity and trust infrastructure sits at the intersection of two problems I find genuinely hard: the technical complexity of building reliable verification rails, and the commercial complexity of selling that reliability to businesses that are understandably sceptical until they see it work. The posting's emphasis on balancing short-term delivery with long-term product architecture is the exact tension I have spent the last several years navigating, most recently on an AI and data platform for a multinational defence programme where the cost of a wrong architectural call is measured in years. The seed-stage context also appeals specifically: a roadmap that is still being discovered is more interesting than one being maintained. *That is exactly the stage where systems thinking compounds fastest.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair-programming and review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, daily development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframing
- **GPT**, research, edge-case generation, draft critique

- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder narratives and decks
-

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, Kafka, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace stripping the headhunter out of construction staffing.

- Matches construction firms with workers using an anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface; LLM agents across the funnel so one operator runs the day-to-day.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; zero-to-one solo build from concept to live users.
 - Demonstrates the same end-to-end ownership Clera needs: discovery, architecture, delivery, and go-to-market without a large team.
-

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT CLERA

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the engineering and commercial teams, map the current identity verification workflow end-to-end, and document where the roadmap assumptions diverge from what customers actually do.

WEEK 2

Slice and sequence.

Take the highest-uncertainty roadmap items, propose testable slices with explicit success criteria, and align on what a confident first ship looks like.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, close.

Drive the first prioritised initiative through delivery, instrument the outcome metric agreed in week two, and use the result to recalibrate the roadmap narrative for the next planning cycle.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Clera team,

Identity and trust infrastructure is not a feature category: it is load-bearing product. Businesses adopt it once and depend on it indefinitely, which means every roadmap decision carries architectural weight far beyond its sprint size. That asymmetry is exactly the kind of problem I have spent my career learning to reason about carefully.

My most directly relevant context is Kvitt Payment Solutions, a fintech B2B payments product I co-founded, took through the Sparkasse integration, and exited into the girocard ecosystem. Before a payment can move, both parties have to trust the rail: I built the verification and consent flows from scratch and watched which edge cases broke trust fastest. More recently at EMIL Group I owned the B2B SaaS platform serving insurers, reinsurers and brokers, which is structurally similar to identity infrastructure: multi-sided, high compliance overhead, and deeply sensitive to downtime. I restructured a struggling 18-person delivery organisation, shipped the Claims Center from zero to production, and cut insurance-product time-to-market from months to under a week.

What I bring to Clera specifically is the combination of platform product experience and the operational discipline to run a distributed team without losing alignment. At Rohde & Schwarz I managed 15+ engineers and data scientists across multinational time zones on the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS programme. I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable in a regulated, high-stakes environment. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned the national labour-market analytics platform as Deputy IT Security Officer, carrying a full containerisation migration and a large ETL overhaul simultaneously. Both roles required the clear, documented decision-making the posting calls out: in distributed teams, undocumented decisions are broken decisions.

The seed-stage context matters to me. I have founded four companies, which means I know what it feels like to own a roadmap that is still being discovered rather than maintained. The constraint of a small team sharpens prioritisation: I default to the cheapest experiment that resolves the highest-risk assumption, and I keep outcome metrics agreed before a feature ships rather than retrofitted afterwards.

I am based in Berlin, work fully within EU time zones, and can start within four weeks of an offer. I would be glad to talk through how my background maps to the specific problems Clera is working on right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership across regulated B2B domains: fintech, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and healthcare. I own roadmaps end-to-end, translate strategy and technical constraints into clear execution plans, and lead distributed cross-functional teams through agile delivery. My fintech and platform background spans a P2P payments product taken to acquisition and a B2B SaaS platform serving insurers and brokers, with consistent focus on outcome metrics, stakeholder alignment, and systems-level thinking about how individual features interact within a larger product ecosystem.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Platform and B2B Product: roadmap ownership, MVP and PoC definition, continuous discovery, product vision, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management, B2B stakeholder alignment.

fintech and payments: P2P payment flow design, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, identity and consent flows, regulated product launch.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, ART and PI planning, backlog refinement, sprint discipline, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence.

SDLC and Delivery Practices: GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, containerised environments, branching strategy, regression and end-to-end test automation, defect-to-fix as product metric.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MicroStrategy, Matomo.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI), Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI & DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout from days to 30 min; 200% pipeline increase by redirecting strategy to developer-code-first; led 15+ engineers and data scientists cross-functionally on the FCAS programme in Scrum.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt cutting data-update time by 75%, and carried full containerisation migration and ETL overhaul while serving as Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM/KIS interface reducing digital anamnesis from 30 min to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B SAAS INSURANCE PLATFORM 2022

Restructured 18-person org into three lean teams, reducing attrition from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from zero to production; cut insurance product time-to-market from months to under one week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL & PAYMENTS POS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix org in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT SECURE DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PM · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING B2B MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero to one solo: anonymity-until-payment model, LLM agents across the funnel, WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, SQL funnel analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer quantum-resistant encryption product installing in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER CDO/CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY & AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built B2B mobile group payments platform from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · CLERA INC.

